

My Birthday

Unbelievable. What the ...? When and how did this happen? The carnage is everywhere, all about me, reflected in reality but it's been a slow-motion crash and dissolution, happening over unnoticed time; with no let up; a sort of disintegration and deterioration proceeding indolently, torpidly, at a snail's pace, an uncaring slow-mo journey of bloom and decay, a meandering of incremental decrepitude, a fraying around the edges till the core starts to rot and the staleness of age descends in its irrecoverably languid squeeze. The rambling passiveness into old age.

I don't like it. I don't want it. I revolt against it in the most strident terms. It can't just wash over me and leave me in its smothering caducity.

Damn. I'm starting to feel old. The way I walk these days is like an old man, an old fart, a stale smell of my youthful self, memory of bygone zest lingering and dissipating slowly into the ether. I'm having trouble with my neck. All these years on from that bike accident and now I feel the real pain associated with ploughing into the ground head first from a youthful need for speed. I walk like a Frankenstein, like any false move might cause my head to fall off, detaching it from the dodgy seams keeping it in place. Unable to move my head without turning my whole body I gaze around frightening young children and shouldering gracefulness aside as my vertebrae click into place and my eyes try to find their focus.

I'm a monster. A monster to my youth. To youth in general. To the force that spawned me and has done with me, spat me out, chewed the juices and savoured the flavours and become tired and bored irritable. Time to refresh. Let the husk go and find fresh fruit.

I can't believe I'm turning thirty!